

Ethics Commission Meeting May 14th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=T10i_OGpAUK
Publication Date	2025-05-15T10:23:22Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Monthly Ethics Commission

Date: May 14

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Jim Low called the May 14 monthly meeting of the Ethics Commission to order at **00:00:23**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chip Taylor, Susan Dylan, WC Edwards (arrived slightly late during roll call), Sandra Whitaker, and Jim Low (Chair).
 - **Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jim Low.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not conducted or mentioned in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **00:01:33** The commission reviewed the minutes of the previous meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Initial Review and Action on Ethics Complaints

The Chair noted prior to deliberation that under commission rules, initial actions on complaints do not include public input, and complaints are referred to solely by complaint number unless an investigation is formally scheduled.

- **00:03:54 Complaint EC25-1**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23. Commissioners noted the complaint lacked sufficient facts to determine a code violation under section 42.01D4.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted at this procedural stage per commission rules.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote (Chip Taylor, yes; Susan Dylan, yes; Jim Low, yes; WC Edwards, yes; Sandra Whitaker, yes).
- **00:05:13 Complaint EC25-2**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:06:17 Complaint EC25-3**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:07:10 Complaint EC25-4**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:08:07 Complaint EC25-5**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:08:54 Complaint EC25-6**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:09:51 Complaint EC25-7**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 15 and reviewed in executive session on April 23.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:10:43 Complaint EC25-8**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:11:43 Complaint EC25-9**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:12:33 Complaint EC25-10**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:13:31 Complaint EC25-11**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:14:22 Complaint EC25-12**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office

- **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.
- **00:15:17 Complaint EC25-13**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / City Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filed on April 22 and reviewed in executive session on April 30.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None permitted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to dismiss passed 5-0 via roll call vote.

Old Business: Adoption of Disclosure Form

- **00:16:11 Adoption of Disclosure Form (Section 40.07)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission considered the adoption of a formal reporting form for disclosing contracts between the city and relatives of employees or elected officials, with no changes made following previous month discussions. The Chair noted that public input is permitted for this item, though no members of the public were present for it.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 5-0 via roll call vote.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note:* The transcript does not feature a traditional open citizen forum with distinct resident speaker turns. However, Commissioner Sandra Whitaker provided a public-facing statement ([00:20:05](#)) addressing attendees present for the complaint reviews, emphasizing that the commission reviewed every complaint thoroughly, point-by-point, in strict adherence to the municipal ethics ordinance.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - [00:17:58](#) The commission acknowledged an announcement regarding Mr. Mason.
 - [00:18:22](#) Jim Low and the Chair noted ongoing work on purchasing documentation for the upcoming transparency portal, to be shared ahead of the next meeting.
 - [00:18:48](#) The commission commended HR Director Patty Goddard for developing concise online training videos regarding boundary issues and ethics compliance for city employees, elected/appointed officials, and board members.
 - **Next Meeting Date:** Scheduled for June 11.

- **Adjournment:**

- 00:21:24 A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and approved. Meeting adjourned.

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